Apex CRM — Win/Loss Analysis Report (Last 2 Quarters)

Audience: Sales Leadership, Marketing, Product
Prepared by: Revenue Operations
Period Covered: Q3–Q4 (Last Two Quarters)
Purpose: Identify patterns in deal outcomes to improve win rates, positioning, and pipeline efficiency

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1. Executive Summary

Over the last two quarters, Apex CRM demonstrated strong performance in mid-market segments, particularly in competitive displacement scenarios involving legacy or overly complex systems. However, losses indicate ongoing challenges in enterprise deals, brand perception, and late-stage competitive pressure from established vendors.

- Overall Win Rate: 38% (↑ from 32% prior period)
- Mid-Market Win Rate (50–200 employees): 46%
- Enterprise Win Rate (>200 employees): 21%

Key Insight:
Apex wins when simplicity, speed, and usability are prioritized—but struggles when buyers default to "safe" enterprise choices.

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2. Pipeline & Deal Metrics

Deal Volume

- Total Opportunities: 312
- Closed Won: 119
- Closed Lost: 193

Average Deal Size

- Q3: $18,500 ARR
- Q4: $21,200 ARR (+14.6% growth)

Trend:

- Increase driven by expansion into larger mid-market accounts
- Higher ACV deals correlate with longer sales cycles and increased competition

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Sales Cycle Length

- Average: 42 days
- Mid-Market: 34 days
- Enterprise: 68 days

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3. Top Reasons for Wins

1. Ease of Use & Adoption (68% of wins)
    - Prospects consistently cited intuitive UI and fast onboarding
    - Strong differentiation vs. Salesforce

"Our team will actually use this" was a recurring theme

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2. Faster Time-to-Value (54% of wins)
    - Ability to deploy in weeks vs. months
    - Particularly impactful for scaling teams

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3. Pricing Transparency & Lower TCO (49% of wins)
    - Clear advantage over HubSpot upsell model
    - Buyers preferred predictable pricing

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4. Sales-Focused Functionality (41% of wins)
    - Better pipeline visibility and forecasting vs. Pipedrive
    - Strong alignment with revenue team needs

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5. Strong AE-Led Discovery & Positioning
    - Deals with clear pain quantification had ~2x higher close rates
    - Successful reps anchored on business outcomes, not features

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4. Top Reasons for Losses

1. Brand Recognition / "Safe Choice" Bias (57% of losses)
    - Prospects defaulted to Salesforce or HubSpot
    - Particularly in enterprise and board-influenced decisions

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2. Perceived Lack of Enterprise Depth (43% of losses)
    - Missing features (real or perceived) in advanced customization
    - Concerns around scalability at large organizations

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3. Late Entry into Sales Cycle (39% of losses)
    - Apex often brought in after requirements were shaped
    - Competitors already positioned as incumbents

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4. Feature Parity Gaps (28% of losses)
- Edge-case requirements (custom reporting, niche integrations)
- Often not critical but influenced decision

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5. Change Aversion / Migration Risk (25% of losses)
- Fear of switching from existing systems
- Especially common with long-time CRM users

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5. Competitive Displacement Analysis

Where Apex Won

Displacement Wins
- Salesforce → Apex: 38 deals
- HubSpot → Apex: 27 deals
- Pipedrive → Apex: 19 deals

Primary Drivers:
- Complexity reduction
- Cost savings
- Improved usability

Where Apex Lost

Competitive Losses
- Apex → Salesforce: 61 deals
- Apex → HubSpot: 49 deals
- Apex → Pipedrive: 18 deals

Primary Drivers:
- Brand trust
- Existing ecosystem lock-in
- Perceived feature completeness

Key Insight

Apex is highly effective in competitive displacement but less effective when positioned as a new entrant vs. incumbent trust.

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6. Deal Size & Segment Trends

SMB (<50 employees)

- Win Rate: 44%
- Challenge: Lower ACV, less urgency
- Trend: Short cycles, price sensitivity

Mid-Market (50–200 employees)
- Win Rate: 46% (highest performing segment)
- Trend: Strong product-market fit
- Key Driver: Outgrowing existing CRM tools

Enterprise (200+ employees)
- Win Rate: 21%
- Challenges:
- Procurement complexity
- Brand bias
- Feature checklist requirements

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7. Strategic Recommendations

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1. Double Down on Mid-Market Focus
- Highest win rates and fastest cycles
- Strongest alignment with Apex value proposition

Action:
- Prioritize ICP targeting (50–200 employees)
- Tailor messaging around scaling teams

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2. Improve Enterprise Positioning
- Address perception gaps, not just product gaps

Action:
- Develop enterprise proof points and case studies
- Strengthen messaging around scalability and security

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3. Win Earlier in the Sales Cycle
- Late-stage entry significantly reduces win probability

Action:
- Increase outbound and top-of-funnel engagement
- Equip AEs with stronger early-stage positioning

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4. Strengthen Competitive Messaging
- Consistency across reps is critical

Action:
- Reinforce battlecard usage
- Train on handling “safe choice” objections

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5. Reduce Migration Friction Concerns
- Switching remains a key barrier

Action:
- Highlight onboarding speed and support
- Introduce clearer migration guarantees/process

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6. Emphasize ROI in Every Deal
- Deals with quantified ROI close significantly more often

Action:
- Standardize ROI modeling in late-stage deals
- Tie product capabilities directly to revenue impact

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8. Key Takeaways

What’s Working
- Strong product-market fit in mid-market
- Clear differentiation on usability and speed
- Effective displacement strategy

What Needs Improvement
- Brand positioning vs. incumbents
- Enterprise credibility
- Early-stage deal influence

Closing Insight

Apex CRM wins when we control the narrative around simplicity, speed, and outcomes—but loses when buyers default to familiarity over value.

End of Report — Internal Use Only